Absolutely. Here’s a real PRD draft for V1.

PRD — U.S. Flashpoints Monitor

Working Name

Flashpoint

Alternate internal names:

- Sentinel
- Overwatch
- Aegis
- Watchtower

Best fit for your stated tone: Flashpoint or Sentinel.

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1. Product Vision

Build a near-real-time U.S. geospatial flashpoints monitoring workstation that ingests public event signals related to unrest, clusters them spatially and temporally, and presents them through a map-first analyst interface.

The product should feel like a clean, tactical analyst system, inspired by Maven / Worldview aesthetics, without becoming a fake sci-fi prop. It should help an operator quickly understand:

- where unrest is happening
- why it matters

- which areas are most important
- whether activity is escalating or spreading

This is not a general news map.

This is not a broad “all hazards” platform.

This is not a predictive policing or surveillance product.

It is a U.S. unrest and flashpoints intelligence monitor.

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2. Product Thesis

Most public information about unrest is fragmented across feeds, articles, alerts, and event records. There is no clear, fast, map-first way to synthesize this into a live operational picture.

Flashpoint solves this by combining:

- event ingestion
- source normalization
- geospatial mapping
- hotspot scoring
- trend detection
- analyst-facing investigation views

into one coherent interface.

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3. MVP Goal

A user opens the platform and, within 10–20 seconds, can answer:

1. Where is unrest happening in the U.S.?
2. Which regions matter most right now?
3. What specific events are driving those hotspots?
4. Is activity escalating, spreading, or cooling?

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4. Target User

Primary user

A solo analyst/operator using the system as a situational awareness tool.

Intended product persona

A hybrid of:

- intelligence operator
- geopolitical monitor
- high-agency analyst

The interface should feel serious, operational, and tactical — but still understandable and usable by one person.

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5. Scope

In Scope for V1

- U.S.-only

- Near-real-time updates every 30–60 minutes
- Event classes:
    - protests
    - riots
    - political violence
    - vandalism tied to unrest
    - police clashes
    - major crowd-related disruptions
    - protest-related road shutdowns/disruptions
- Map-based event display
- Heatmap layer
- Clickable event markers
- Hotspot scoring
- Top-3 priority regions/events
- Event detail pane
- Trend indicators
- Source-backed event records
- Confidence scoring
- Multi-panel desktop workstation UI

Out of Scope for V1

- handheld Pi Zero terminal
- global coverage
- collaborative users
- login/accounts
- predictive forecasting
- satellite/video imagery analysis
- voice interface
- full natural-language briefing engine
- polished mobile experience
- advanced official-alert workflow beyond corroboration
- any people-level identification or surveillance

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6. Core Product Principles

1. Map first

The system is centered on a U.S. operational map, not a feed.

2. Events + areas

The map must show both:

- specific events
- larger hotspot intensity

3. Source-backed, not fake

Every meaningful event should be tied to sources or structured records.

4. Operator speed

The UI should answer the core questions fast.

5. Controlled judgment

The system can use analytic language like:

- elevated
- emerging hotspot
- sustained unrest signal
- escalating

But should avoid overclaiming.

6. Tactical, not theatrical

The system should feel cinematic and high-end, but still credible.

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7. Primary User Story

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8. Functional Overview

Core jobs to be done

A. Live monitoring

Monitor recent unrest-related activity across the U.S.

B. Pattern detection

Identify clusters, spikes, and escalation trends.

C. Investigation

Drill into specific metros/regions/events to understand what is happening and why.

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9. Event Model

The core object is an Event.

Each event should ideally include:

- event_id
- title / short label
- event_type
- timestamp
- location
- lat/lon
- city
- state
- summary
- source_count
- source_list
- confidence_score

- severity_score
- cluster_id
- trend_status
- tags
- related_events

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10. Event Classes for V1

Included

- protest
- riot
- political violence
- police clash
- vandalism tied to unrest
- crowd-related disruption
- protest-related road shutdown

Excluded

- generic crime
- unrelated emergency incidents
- weather-only incidents

- ordinary traffic accidents
- non-unrest public safety events unless strongly linked to unrest context

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11. Key Concepts

Event

A specific unrest-related incident or reported occurrence.

Hotspot

A geographic area with elevated flashpoint activity based on event concentration, severity, and corroboration.

Cluster

A grouping of nearby events in time and space.

Trend

The direction of change for a cluster or region:

- rising
- stable
- cooling

Confidence

How strongly the platform believes the event/hotspot is real and meaningful based on source support and signal consistency.

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12. Hotspot Logic

The system should support both:

1. Heatmap layer

A visual density/intensity layer showing where unrest activity is concentrated.

2. Hotspot scoring layer

Named or inferred hotspot areas with operational labels such as:

- watch
- elevated
- serious
- critical

Hotspot intensity should consider:

- number of events
- source count
- recentness
- severity
- geographic density
- evidence of spread/escalation

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13. Priority Logic

The system should surface a Top 3 Most Pressing Areas / Situations.

Ranking inputs

In priority order:

1. Severity
2. Momentum
3. Source strength
4. Geographic spread
5. Strategic importance

Example output style

- Bay Area, CA — Elevated
  - 8 unrest-related events in last 6 hours
  - cluster density rising
  - multi-source corroboration
- Atlanta Metro — Escalating
  - police clash + repeated protest activity
- Chicago Core — Watch
  - increased event volume, moderate confidence

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14. Confidence Model

Each event and hotspot should have a confidence score or level.

Inputs into confidence

- number of corroborating sources
- source quality mix
- event detail completeness
- agreement across records
- recency
- location precision

Suggested confidence levels

- low
- medium
- high

Or numeric:

- 0.00–1.00

For V1, numeric internally and labeled publicly is best.

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15. Trend Model

Each hotspot/cluster gets a trend state:

- rising

- stable
- cooling

Trend should consider:

- event count change over recent windows
- change in severity
- spread into nearby areas
- repeated mentions in short periods

Example display:

- Escalating ↑
- Cooling ↓
- Stable →

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16. Data Sources

The platform should use a mix of:

- public APIs
- structured datasets
- RSS/news feeds
- official alerts as corroborating overlays

- manually normalized event data if needed

Source philosophy

Use sources that improve:

- timeliness
- credibility
- geospatial precision
- event categorization

Official alerts are secondary, except when they indicate high-significance states like:

- emergency declarations
- state of emergency
- major threat/crisis notices

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17. Update Cadence

V1 refresh strategy

- ingest new data every 30 minutes
- allow dashboard auto-refresh
- update hotspot scoring on each ingest cycle
- maintain freshness timestamps throughout UI

System language

Use:

- Last updated
- Source freshness
- Updated X min ago

Do not imply literal second-by-second live accuracy.

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18. Core Screens

1. Main Command View — Primary Screen

This is the default landing screen.

Layout

Center: U.S. map

Left rail: filters / layers / controls

Right rail: top priorities + selected event/hotspot detail

Bottom panel: live feed / timeline / recent changes

Purpose

Quickly answer:

- where activity is concentrated
- what matters most
- what changed recently

This is the most important screen in the product.

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19. Main Command View Components

A. U.S. Map

Must support:

- event markers
- heatmap overlay
- zoom and pan
- cluster grouping
- click to inspect event/hotspot

B. Top Priorities Pane

Shows:

- top 3 pressing areas/events
- severity
- trend
- confidence
- short why-it-matters line

C. Event Feed / Change Feed

Shows:

- newest event records
- new cluster formation
- rising hotspots
- downgraded or cooling areas

D. Detail Pane

When user clicks a marker/hotspot:

- title
- location
- event type
- timestamp
- summary
- confidence
- source list/count
- tags
- nearby related events
- cluster/trend context

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20. Secondary Screens

A. Region / Metro Drilldown View

Focused view for a selected metro/cluster.

Shows:

- zoomed map
- all related events
- local timeline
- event breakdown
- cluster trend

B. Timeline View

Chronological mode showing:

- event volume over time
- severity shifts
- hotspot trend changes

C. Event Record View

Single-record detail page/panel.

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21. Filters

V1 filters should include:

- date/time window
- event type

- state
- region
- confidence
- severity
- source count
- trend state

Optional later:

- source type
- actor categories
- official-alert overlay toggle

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22. UI / Visual Direction

Visual target

A hybrid of:

- clean and serious
- tactical and map-centric
- selectively cinematic

Desired feel

- dark mode first
- high contrast
- restrained glow/accent usage
- premium analyst workstation
- not cluttered
- not “hacker dashboard”
- not fake military cosplay

Design direction

Clean system underneath, cinematic touches on top

Acceptable touches

- subtle pulse animations
- controlled glow for hotspots
- scanline/CRT influence only if extremely restrained
- layered paneling
- topographic/grid texture in background

Avoid

- cheesy HUD clutter
- too many meaningless numbers
- fake telemetry

- overdone glitch effects
- unreadable tiny text

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23. MVP AI Layer

AI in V1 should be moderate, not dominant.

In scope

- source normalization help
- event categorization support
- short summary generation for event detail
- optional hotspot explanation snippets

Out of scope for MVP

- full daily brief engine
- autonomous analyst narrative
- predictive forecasting
- advanced LLM chat interface

Example acceptable AI output

Short, factual, structured.

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24. Backend Framing

For the PRD and pitch, the backend should be described as:

a geospatial flashpoints monitor and analyst workstation

Secondarily:

an event intelligence engine

This framing is stronger than “dashboard.”

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25. Ontology / Data Model

Primary objects

- Event
- Location
- Hotspot
- Source
- Cluster
- TrendWindow

Relationships

- Event occurred_at Location
- Event derived_from Source

- Event belongs_to Cluster
- Cluster forms Hotspot
- Hotspot has_trend TrendWindow
- Event related_to nearby Event

This is enough for V1 to sound serious without becoming bloated.

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26. Success Metrics for MVP

The MVP succeeds if a user can:

1. Open the platform and identify the top 3 hotspots quickly
2. Click into a hotspot and understand what events are driving it
3. Distinguish rising vs cooling areas
4. Trust that event records are source-backed
5. Feel that the system is live, coherent, and operational

Non-quantitative success signal

It should feel like:

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27. Technical MVP Scope

Must-have

- ingestion pipeline
- event normalization
- storage
- U.S. map
- event markers
- heatmap
- hotspot scoring
- top-3 priorities
- detail pane
- update cadence
- trend states

Nice-to-have

- summary generation
- smoother clustering
- advanced animations
- official alert overlays
- source ranking refinement

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28. Risks

1. Source noise

If sources are inconsistent, event quality may vary.

2. Overbreadth

Trying to cover too many incident categories will weaken the system.

3. Fake sophistication

Too much cinematic styling without strong data logic will make it feel shallow.

4. Overclaiming

The system must avoid pretending certainty where it only has partial signal.

5. UI clutter

A tactical style can become unreadable if overloaded.

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29. Product Risks to Guard Against

Explicitly avoid becoming:

- a generic news map
- a broad crisis tracker
- a fake AI command center
- a political statement machine
- a surveillance product
- a speculative forecasting tool in V1

30. MVP Build Order

Phase 1

Backend + data model

- define event schema
- set up ingest pipeline
- normalize sources
- store records

Phase 2

Map + UI shell

- U.S. map
- event markers
- heatmap
- detail pane
- top priorities

Phase 3

Hotspot logic

- clustering
- scoring

- trend states

Phase 4

Refinement

- better summaries
- better UI polish
- evidence improvements

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31. V1 Product Statement

Flashpoint is a near-real-time U.S. unrest and flashpoints monitoring workstation that fuses public event signals into a map-first analyst interface with hotspot scoring, trend detection, and source-backed event investigation.

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32. Resume / portfolio framing

A strong way to describe it later:

That is strong because it emphasizes:

- ingestion
- geospatial intelligence

- clustering
- analyst workflow
- real interface design